Feedback After Reading the Prologue

K. Steven Kunstler: I couldn't keep up with how the music and the changes in the music jived with the dialogue. I couldn't quite figure that part out.

Cate Cammarata: I liked the way you built the Petoskey rock. I thought that was beautiful, that really enhanced it for me. Also when you had the underscore for the Banh Mi section. I leaned into that for the strings of more of an Asian sound because it's on a different mode.

Shira Levin: I thought the music sounded beautiful to me. In terms of story, I don't know what was happening when we were hearing this music. Musically, it was intriguing. The story and how it fits, I can't really comment. It's a blur for me right now for me. I'm intrigued by what you said that it's about grief. I've written about grief myself. I've got from a little bit we've read that you said that Petey kills himself. I guess we have to make sure we know who he is upfront and then when the suicide happens, it will have more meaning for us. Again, I cannot comment without having read further.

K. Steven Kunstler: In my mind for introducing Michigan… having some sort of narrative device to go and share that "Michigan is the most diverse place" and "we celebrate these different communities and we get together on these dates" and "we celebrate our differences and we appreciate our different cuisines" and whatever is relevant to your story. Having some kind of narrative that lets the audience in on this. This is all very clear to you because this is your story. But it's not clear to us.

Cate Cammarata: You need a narrator like Usnavi from *In The Heights*.

Shira Levin: I thought this story has a narrator. Lizzie.

Cate Cammarata: I thought Lizzie was the narrator, but then I lost it.

Shira Levin: Yeah, she's not narrating in the way that we're talking about. But you can use her. You just have to get clearer on what you need to narrate, what you need to explain, and what we can figure out through the drama. She can be it.

Cate Cammarata: Let Lizzie take us by the hand and lead us through all of this more. I thought it was Lizzie but then I lost it.

Shira Levin: Or it could be someone else, maybe not in the family, or a neighbor or does not have to go back and forth from narration to interacting.

Cate Cammarata: I think there's got to be points of clarity to latch onto it.

K. Steven Kunstler: Once again, just to share random thoughts, it strikes me that having an outsider might be a workable device. "I'm the new guy in the neighborhood and it never cease to amaze me what an incredible community this is. There are people from here and there and next place, and this guy down the street, he's like this and blah blah blah. And this guy runs his restaurant. I can't believe blah blah blah you know. Something where you can create and present the world of your show in some kind of narrative format that doesn't necessarily need to be one of the characters. It's just a question of what suits your story. I can see a lot of different ways to present it, so that it all can congeal for the audience to really get a grasp of what you're trying to do.

Shira Levin: It could be like *Our Town* by Thornton Wilder. I think you want to focus on the people, the characters, that to me personally what's always going to be compelling and then that all the other stuff you will probably be able to do that. The characters are who we are going to be following, not the ins and outs of the specific. The spirit of Michigan will come across because of who the family is and what their traditions are and we see them doing those things.

Cate Cammarata: Bringing up *Oklahoma* and *In The Heights*, those are two musicals about a specific place. You've named this musical *Michigan*, so it's about a specific place and a specific part of *Michigan*. Maybe, the opening number needs to be set the world for me because I've been to Detroit once as a kid. And that's it. You've got to introduce the audience to the location.